

Unit Y315: The Changing Nature of Warfare 1792–1945

This theme focuses on the changing nature and methods of land warfare during a period of significant change. Learners should draw their examples from the main wars of the period: the Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars, the Crimean War, the Wars of Unification (the 1859 Italian War, the Austro-Prussian War of 1866 and the Franco-Prussian war of 1870–1871), the American Civil War, the Russo-Japanese war, the First World War and the

Second World War. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Changing Nature of Warfare 1792–1945	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The impact of factors directly related to the conduct of war	Generalship and its impact; quality of soldiers including professional armies and volunteers and their impact; the development of strategy, the aims of campaigns and their determination; the development of tactics, shock tactics, cult of the offensive; the work of military theorists; the concept of ‘Total War’, the involvement of civilians, casualties.
The impact of technological change	Industrialisation and technology; developments in communication and transport including telegraph, radio, telephone and radar, steamboats, railways, internal combustion engine; development of weaponry including the rifle, artillery developments, machine gun, tanks, aeroplane.
Planning and preparation	The effectiveness of alliances and military plans; developments in the organisation, command and control of armies.
The relationship between relevant domestic factors and warfare	The organisation of the state for war, recruitment, the procurement and delivery of supplies, the scale of war, government intervention; public opinion, morale, patriotism and the impact of mass literacy, franchise and the popular press, censorship; conscription; economics and the cost of war, the mobilisation of the economy, mass production; manpower and resources.

The Changing Nature of Warfare 1792–1945	
Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
The French Revolutionary Wars 1792–1802	Generalship; the quality of the soldiers; the development of tactics and strategy; developments in communication; developments in weaponry; the effectiveness of alliances; developments in the organisation, command and control of the armies; conscription; manpower and resources.
The American Civil War 1861–1865	Generalship; the quality of the soldiers; the development of tactics and strategy; developments in communication; industrialisation; developments in communication and transport; developments in weaponry; the effectiveness of alliances; developments in the organisation, command and control of the armies; public opinion; conscription; manpower and resources.
The Western Front and the First World War 1914–1918	Generalship; the quality of the soldiers; the development of tactics and strategy; military theorists; the concept of Total War; developments in communication; industrialisation; developments in communication and transport; developments in weaponry; the effectiveness of alliances; developments in the organisation, command and control of the armies; the organisation of the state for war; public opinion; conscription; manpower and resources.